

 Politeknik Negeri Bandung	General English 2	
	Lecturer: Muhammad Yazidus Syukri, S.S., M.Pd.	Skill focus: Reading
	Duration: 4 x 50'	Topic 3: Contextual References
Equipment:	Whiteboard, board marker, handout, LDC projector, laptop, screen	
Objectives:	After completing this lesson, you will be able to: 1. Identify the references of pronouns: personal pronoun as subject, personal pronoun as an object, Possessive adjective, possessive pronoun, reflexive pronoun, demonstrative pronoun, and relative pronoun. 2. Use the transitional markers 3. Able to differentiate between an opinion and a factual information	
Student's name:		Date: February 2022

Writers do not like to use the same words many times. They use other words which mean almost the same thing. In this unit, you are going to learn how pronouns and some other related words are used for this purpose.

Transition markers are words used to link ideas together so that the text is easier to read. When pronouns such *as it, they, them, I, him, he, she, who, whose, that, such, one*, and demonstrative adjectives such as *this, that, these* and *those*, are used as transitional markers, they refer to a word, or words, mentioned earlier in the sentence or paragraph. The function is to take refer backward are *the former, the latter, the first, the second*, etc. *the last*.

Pronoun

Personal pronoun as Subject	Personal pronoun as Object	Possessive adjective	Possessive pronoun	Reflexive pronoun	Demonstrative pronoun	Relative pronoun
I We You	Me Us You	My Our Your	Mine Ours Yours	Myself Ourselves Yourself / Yourselves	This That These Those	Who Whose Whom Which That
They He She It	Them Him Her It	Theirs His Hers Its	Theirs His Hers Its	Themselves Himself Herself Itself		

Now, study the following paragraph; the pronouns are underlined.

Example:

Mary Simms lives in New York City. She has an apartment near central park. Mary jogs in the park. She thinks that jogging is good for her. So, she jogs three times a week

She, she, her, and she relates to one person, that is Mary Simms. "Mary Simms" is called *the referent*.

Another example:

Jogging is good for your health for a few reasons. It is especially good for your heart. If you do it a few days a week, your heart will be stronger. It is also good for you legs. And many people believe it is good for your mind.

It takes the place of the noun _____, _____ is the referent.

[illegible]

Task 3

In this passage the pronouns are underlined. Write their referents in the blanks.

Jogging is a very popular activity in New York City. In the winter, the weather is too cold for it. But, in the spring, it is warmer, and many New Yorkers go out to jog in Central Park. This is a very good place to run.

Other New Yorkers go out to jog in Central Park. Many of them go there with their dogs. Dogs can run in the park. Sometimes the dogs run after the joggers. They may try to bite them. The dog owners do not understand. They wonder why joggers do not like dogs. The park police are trying to solve this problem. They want all of the people to use the park in peace.

Pronouns	Referent

Sometimes, pronouns can take the place of a group of words.

Example A

The Central Park of police officer often meets dangerous people. Some people go to the park to steal. Other people are there to sell drugs. And sometimes serious gun fights start in the park. The park police officer may meet any of **these** in the park.

Pronouns

these

Referents

people who steal
People who steal drugs
People who start gunfights

Example B

It is not easy to be the mayor of a large American city. Many people need homes and jobs. The buildings and streets need to be fixed. The schools are old, and the students are not learning enough. The streets are dangerous at night because of crime. **These** are big problems, and the mayor must work on all of **them**.

Pronouns

these
them

Referents

HOW TO MAKE ACCURATE INFERENCES

Look up the meanings of any unfamiliar words and consider the definitions in context.

Think about the possibilities of interpretation by examining the writer's words and phrases.

Look carefully at the way the statement is worded. Then return to the passage and locate the pertinent passage. Test the statement for accuracy.

Remember that inferences are *statements of probability*, not facts. They proceed from facts, but they are not facts themselves.

If you are in doubt about an answer, ask your instructor for help or for further clarification.

In order to make reliable inferences, you need to pay close attention to the passage. First, look up the meaning of any unfamiliar words. You can't interpret a passage accurately if you don't know what the writer is saying. For example, in the preceding passage, Barasch describes the neighborhood's problems as "endemic." Although you can probably get his general meaning without knowing the exact definition of "endemic," you might not make the connection between the bakery's troubles and these problems (drugs and poor educational skills). There is a big difference between temporary, easily solved problems and endemic ones that are entrenched and not easily solved.

If you are unsure about an answer, ask your instructor for help or for further clarification. If your college has a reading laboratory where tutoring is available, you might avail yourself of its services. Finally, remember that good readers may sometimes disagree over the answers because inferences are not always black and white. That's what makes them fun and challenging.

The second type of inference question is open-ended, requiring you to answer the question in your own words. For this final exercise, read the following article posted on the website of the *Chronicle of Higher Education* in December 2011. Open-ended inference questions follow it.

WASHINGTON D.C.—many employers believe colleges aren't adequately preparing students for jobs, according to findings of a study presented here on Monday by the Accrediting Council for Independent Colleges and Schools. The group surveyed more than 1,000 employers in various industries last month about whether job applicants possess the skills to thrive in the workplace. More than half of employers said finding qualified applicants is difficult, and just under half thought students should receive specific workplace training rather than a more broad-based education. At a news conference announcing those findings, Rep. Virginia Foxx, the North Carolina Republican who is chairwoman of the U.S. House of Representatives higher-education subcommittee, urged institutions to heed employers' calls. "Colleges and universities are pandering to the students and giving them what they want, instead of what the employers want," she said. "I don't think you have to make a distinction between getting skills and getting an education. We need to do both." According to the survey results, less than 10 percent of employers thought colleges did an "excellent" job of preparing students for work. Nearly 30 percent said finding the right applicant has grown harder in the past few years. On all hiring criteria included in the survey, such as adaptability and critical thinking, applicants were performing below employers' expectations. Also on Monday, the accrediting council announced a Student Success Initiative to conduct further research and encourage colleges to focus on job training and placement.

Lacey Johnson, "Employers Say College Graduates Lack Job Skills," *The Chronicle of Higher Education*, www.chronicle.com, December 5, 2011. Copyright 2011, *The Chronicle of Higher Education*. Reprinted with permission.

Task 4

SMALL GROUP ACTIVITY—OPEN-ENDED INFERENCES

Working in groups of three or four, discuss these inference questions and then write your answers to the inference questions that follow in the space provided. If you are unsure about whether or not you can make an inference, write “can’t tell because there’s not enough information.” Your instructor will compare the various groups’ answers and evaluate them to check for accuracy.

1. According to the majority of businesses who responded to the survey, colleges and universities have the responsibility to train their students for jobs in the workplace. What is one reason that business owners might feel this way?

2. According to the article, what specific skills are employers looking for? Are the two mentioned properly considered “skills”?

3. Who is best suited to teach these—universities or employers?

4. What are some skills that aren’t mentioned that employers might be looking for?

5. What does the word *pander* in the third paragraph most likely mean? What do students want?

6. Is the fact that Representative Virginia Foxx of South Carolina is a Republican of any significance?

7. What do you think college and university faculty would say about the survey results?

8. Whom does the accrediting council (mentioned at the beginning and again at the end) support in this discussion?

As you might imagine, this article generated a lot of comments. You can read these for yourself by locating the article at www.chronicle.com. Type in the article title and scroll down to the bottom to see the readers’ comments

Task 5

The pronouns in this passage are underlined. Circle the referents.

1. Two Frenchmen went up in a basket under a balloon. They built a fire to make the air hot. This made the balloon stay up in the air
2. The pilot of a balloon can control altitude. He can rise and lower the balloon to find good wind direction. That is how a good pilot can control where the balloon goes.
3. Early photographers had to carry film and heavy equipment everywhere they went. But this did not stop them.
4. Helen Keller was deaf and blind. She could not speak until she was seven years old. But these problems did not stop her. She became a famous writer and teacher.
5. A tornado is a very dangerous storm. It brings strong winds and it travels very fast. The strong winds can blow over cars, destroy houses, and kill people. And this happens in just a few minutes.
6. Tornadoes blow dust and dirt into the air. They make a cone shape in the sky. When people see this, they get ready for the storm.
7. When tornadoes touch the ground, they move along at about 35 to 45 kilometers per hour. No one knows which way they go.
8. In a small town, a tornado can destroy a street full of homes and stores. Many people can be killed. The government tries to help when this happens.
9. Tornadoes are common in the middle part of the United States. Kansas, Arkansas, Nebraska, Iowa, and Missouri are states with many tornadoes every year. People in those states worry when they see a cone-shaped cloud in the sky.
10. The wind of a tornado is strong. No one knows exactly how fast the wind is in the center. The wind always breaks the machine for measuring it.

Related Words: Specific to General

Related words are words that relate to the same idea and replace the noun or groups of noun for the purpose of the pronouns. Now, study the following example.

Example 1:

David had a wonderful trip to Paris this spring. He loved the beautiful buildings in the French capital. To him it was a city full of magic and beauty.

What does “French capital” refer to? Paris. What does “city refer” to? Paris. So, French capital, city and Paris are related words.

Example 2:

The Pope visited Columbia, Peru, and Mexico last year. Crowds of Catholics greeted him in these countries. It was his first visit to that part of the world.

What does “these countries” relate to? _____

What does “that part of the world” relate to? _____

Both phrases are related to? _____

When the writers use related words, the second word is usually less specific, and the next is even more general. Study the underlined words in *Example 1*, “Paris” is specific, but “French capital” is less specific, and “city” is even more general than Paris and French capital.

In *Example 2*, which words are specific? _____; less specific? _____; and general? _____

Now, in the following practice you will learn to put words in the order from specific to general.

PRACTICE

Task 6

Put these related words in order from specific to general. Put number 1 above the most specific, number 2 above the less specific, and number 3 above the most general words. No. 1 is done as an example.

- | | | |
|-----|---|----------------|
| 3 | 1 | 2 |
| 1. | Music, rock music, twentieth- | century music. |
| 2. | Japanese mountain, Mount Fuji, mountain. | |
| 3. | Problems, water pollution problems, pollution problems. | |
| 4. | Pine tree, evergreen tree, tree. | |
| 5. | Musician, Michael Jackson, popular musician. | |
| 6. | Nicaragua, country, Central America country. | |
| 7. | Man, Dr. Diamond, dentist. | |
| 8. | Place, Boston, city. | |
| 9. | The New York Times, newspaper, reading material. | |
| 10. | Group, Diamond family, people. | |
| 11. | Storm, tornado, wind storm. | |
| 12. | President, person, political leader. | |
| 13. | Shirt, white shirt, clothing. | |
| 14. | Flute, musical instrument, wind instrument. | |
| 15. | Company, PT Telkom, organization. | |

Task 7

In each passage, there is a word underlined. Find and circle the related words in the passage.

- Liz and Val moved to Paris last month. They like the city very much.
- Hiroko plays the violin in the Boston Symphony Orchestra. The sound of this stringed instrument is very special.
- The president of the city council gave a long speech. As the leader, she has to plan many projects.
- The tornado hit a small town in Kansas. The storm swept down the main street. The terrible winds caused five stores to fall down.
- Lemons, limes, and oranges are all very good to eat. These citrus fruits are also very healthy for you. They are a good source of vitamin C.
- Many Americans skip breakfast. They say they do not have time for food in the morning. But this is a mistake. The human body needs that meal.
- Joanne's big car uses a lot of gasoline. She has to stop often to fill the tank with fuel.
- We saw a lion with three little cubs at the wild animal park. The cats were lying on the rocks in the warm afternoon sun. We were happy to see such wonderful animals in such a nice place.
- In some countries, the winter is long and cold. It is not a very popular season. Some people are also unhappy at that time of the year, and they get sick.
- Astronauts from the United States and the Soviet Union all have one problem: They get motion sickness. This illness makes it difficult to do their work. Doctors and scientist are working on this problem.

Task 8 Integrated Practice

Read each paragraph, and then write what the underlined words refer to.

- The pyramids on the west bank of the Nile were built by the pharaohs as royal tombs. They date from 3000 BC. The most celebrated are those at Giza, built during the fourth dynasty, of which the largest is the one that housed the pharaoh Khufu, better known as Cheops. This is now called the Great Pyramid.

2. In 1337 King Edward did something special for his eldest son, Prince Edward: he created the title of Duke of Cornwall and a duchy to go with it. For most of the next 644 Years, the duchy has provided a generous income for the Duke. Prince Charles is the twenty-fourth heir to the throne to hold this title.
-
-

3. The streets of Manhattan are a frontier, a no man's land. In the business districts, they interrupt the flow of civilized behavior. Contrasting with the seeming orderliness of the buildings that border them. If there were laws regulating New York City traffic, they are barely enforced. There are approximately six hundred bicycle messengers working in Manhattan. They are fast and contemptuous of whatever traffic rules there are. They intimidate pedestrians and alarm the drivers of other vehicles competing with them for space and on the road.
-
-

4. The Voyager 2 spacecraft provided astronomers with new information concerning Saturn's rings. Instead of being concentric circles, a few of them seem more like the spiraling grooves of a phonograph record. The ring spirals may come from forces similar to those that pushed the Milky Way galaxy into two spiral arms. If an outer moon pushed and pulled a spinning sheet of particles, it would eventually become denser at certain spots in its orbit. This clump would then tug on nearby particles, herding them into a dense ring whirling around the planet. Voyager 2 detected traits that look like such spiral density waves in Saturn's A ring. It also returned pictures showing that some of the rings are not perfect circles.
-
-

5. Altogether, the engineer made over one hundred refinements and improvements in their latest model. The most impressive thing about it, however, is what they did not change. And that is its classic exterior design. If you want an automobile with a look that will never become outmoded, you should consider this one.
-
-

6. The American Museum of Natural History spent four years arranging its extraordinary exhibition of more than 500 pieces of ancient gold from Colombia. But those few years are brief time when compared with the decades archeologist have spent digging for and studying gold artifacts. And all the time is short when compared with the many centuries prehistoric Indians practice their craftsmanship and artistry to create these treasures.
-
-

7. A small group of scientists do not believe that dinosaur became extinct because they were big, clumsy beasts. Through their painstaking studies, these researchers are trying to prove what really happened to those giant yesteryear on the basis of a theory that will astonish many: they think the cause of their demise came from outer space.
-
-

8. In its winding course to the Mississippi, the Wisconsin helps to give power to plants, factories, and mills, making it one of America's hardest working rivers. And through that same course, it also proves itself to become one of the most beautiful rivers in the world. Like their river, Wisconsinites see no contradiction between hard work and natural beauty. Their fertile farmlands are an ode to natural beauty and productive enough to make them the nation's leading producers of milk, butter, and cheese.
-
-

EXERCISE IN DISTINGUISHING BETWEEN FACT AND OPINION

A *fact* is a statement that can be verified or proved either by measurement, observation, or some other form of proof. An *opinion* represents someone's subjective interpretation and therefore can't be verified or proved. You have already seen one of these exercises in Part Two, and more are coming up in Parts Three and Four of the text. Practice with these assertions from the article you just read. Write F if the statement represents a factual statement that can be verified or O if the statement represents the writer's or someone else's subjective interpretation.

Task 9

Decide whether the following sentences belong to opinion (O) or fact (F)

- ___1. Many employers believe colleges aren't adequately preparing students for jobs.
- ___2. Colleges aren't adequately preparing students for jobs.
- ___3. The Accrediting Council for Independent Colleges and Schools surveyed more than 1,000 employers in various industries.
- ___4. More than half of the employers surveyed think that finding qualified applicants is difficult.
- ___5. Slightly less than half of the employers surveyed think that students should receive workplace training rather than a more broad-based education.
- ___6. Colleges and universities are pandering to students by giving them what they want, according to Representative Virginia Foxx, a Republican from North Carolina.
- ___7. Representative Foxx believes that colleges and universities can teach students skills and give them an education at the same time.
- ___8. Based on two criteria—adaptability and critical thinking—applicants are performing below employers' expectations.
- ___9. Finding the right applicant has been getting harder for employers in the past few years.
- ___10. The accrediting council is encouraging colleges to focus on job training and placement.

Note:

Questions for Discussion

Task 10

These questions involve further work in making inferences by asking you to respond to the various implications the article raises.

1. How well does the writer explain employers' concerns about college graduates who work for them? What other information might she have included?

2. Do you see anything illogical in this statement from paragraph 2: "just under half [of employers surveyed] thought students should receive specific workplace training rather than a more broad-based education"?

3. Have your own lower-division required college courses been geared toward a "broad-based education" or toward getting useful skills that you can employ in the workplace? Are you getting what you expected from them?

4. What *should* be the role of colleges and universities? Do you agree with Representative Virginia Foxx's assessment that "colleges and universities are pandering to the students and giving them what they want, instead of what the employers want"?

5. How likely is it that a college or university could adequately perform job training for its students? How worthwhile would that training likely be in a real corporation or business?

❖ A final note:

The inference-making process shows you the importance of reading carefully. In my experience both in teaching reading courses and, even more, in tutoring students one-on-one in reading, I have observed the wild flights of fancy students often indulge in. They read things into a passage that aren't there and the writer hasn't implied. These speculations result often in students completely misunderstanding what a writer says. Some other reasons for errors in reading are inattention or poor concentration, lack of vocabulary, or unfamiliarity with the subject matter. But inferences remain the most difficult area requiring improvement. If you diligently apply the recommendations discussed in this introduction, it will also result in better, more accurate reading and a depth of understanding that superficial comprehension of only the main points cannot provide.